



Alan Foster Paterson

1893 - 1916

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Alan Foster Paterson There are more than one spelling of his first and middle names. See Notes	NB: only one T in surname See Notes: on the General Register (BMD) he is registered as Allan Forster Paterson and the same in the baptism register (have saved files)
Date of Birth	22/5/1893	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/ Also: baptism entry, original doc on Ancestry confirms date of birth but spelt his name as Allan Forster Paterson
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	1/7/1916	

Age at death (from Spreadsheet	23	There is doubt about age on Scott's master spreadsheet which said he was 35 See Notes – he was actually 23
Marital Status		
Children (if any)	Bank Clerk	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
Occupation prior to Call up		
Parents	James & Hannah	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
Listed Address(s)	26 Glenhouse Road, Eltham, London	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
Parents /Fathers occupation	Clerk at the War Office	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
Brothers and Sisters	One brother only: Private James Cochrane Paterson who died in 1915 while held captive by the Germans	https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary		
<i>Additional sources of data</i>		
There is a memorial page with pic on CWGC website – see Notes		https://www.cwgc.org/stories/stories/lieutenant-alan-foster-paterson-middlesex-regiment-attd-to-2nd-battalion-royal-fusiliers/
He is on the Trinity Presbyterian Church, Hindes Road, Harrow, war memorial	Name spelt: Allan F Paterson	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11182
More info???		

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	PATERSON A.F.
CWGC Reference	Lieutenant Alan Foster Paterson War Casualty Details 808537 CWGC
Age	23
DoD	01-Jul-16
Rank	Lt
Regiment	Middlesex Regiment
	THIEPVAL MEMORIAL
Location	Somme, France
Military details	Lt Alan Paterson was born in Hendon, Middlesex, on 22nd May 1893, the younger of two children, both sons of James (a clerk at the War Office) and Hannah Paterson of 26 Glenhouse Road, Eltham, London. He was employed as a bank clerk. He received a commission in the 14th Battalion, Middlesex Regiment, on 26th February 1915, went to Egypt on 1st December and afterwards proceeded to France. Lieutenant Alan Foster Paterson died on July 1, 1916, at the age of 23. While commissioned into the Middlesex Regiment, he was serving on detached duty, attached to the 2nd Battalion of the Royal Fusiliers (part of the 86th Brigade, 29th Division). Because he was reported missing and his body was never recovered or identified, Lieutenant Paterson has no known grave. He is officially commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial to the Missing of the Somme in France (Pier and Face 12 D and 13 B). The actions that claimed his life took place directly in front of the heavily fortified German strongpoint at Hawthorn Ridge and Beaumont-Hamel, in the Somme region of northern France. He was killed in action on the First Day of the Battle of the Somme, universally remembered as the bloodiest single day in the history of the British Army. : At exactly 7:20 AM, a massive British mine hidden underneath the German fortification at Hawthorn Ridge was detonated, blowing a monumental crater into the earth. This signaled an immediate 10-minute British heavy artillery barrage before the infantry advanced. Because the infantry did not attack until 7:30 AM, the 10-minute gap gave surviving German machine gunners plenty of time to scramble out of their deep dugouts. They quickly set up defensive positions around the rim of the brand-new crater and along the undamaged parapets. When the whistle blew at 7:30 AM, Lieutenant Paterson and the men of the 2nd Royal Fusiliers climbed out of their trenches and advanced into No Man's Land toward Hawthorn Ridge. As soon as they stepped into the open, they were met by a devastating, cross-cutting wall of machine-gun and concentrated artillery fire. The battalion faced near-total annihilation trying to cross the open ground, and Lieutenant Paterson was among the wave of officers cut down in the first hours of the attack. Alan's parents lost both their children in the war as his brother, Private James Cochrane Paterson, 2950, 'A' Company, 9th Battalion, Royal Sussex Regiment, died on 21st October 1915, aged 25. He died of wounds while in German hands and is buried in grave XVII.A.11 in Cologne Southern Cemetery.

Story of Sacrifice

Alan Foster Paterson (1893 – 1916)

Alan Foster Paterson attended the John Lyon School before becoming a bank clerk and receiving a commission in the Middlesex Regiment in 1915, later serving in Egypt and France. He was killed aged 23 on 1 July 1916 while attacking Hawthorn Ridge during the Battle of the Somme and, having no known grave, is commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial.

Civilian Life

Alan Foster Paterson was born on 22 May 1893 in Hendon, Middlesex, the younger of two sons of James and Hannah Paterson. His father was a 1st Class Assistant Accountant in the War Office, and the family lived in Harrow. Alan attended the John Lyon School and by 1911 was working as a bank clerk, as was his elder brother, James.

Military Life

Paterson received a commission in the 14th Battalion, Middlesex Regiment, on 26 February 1915. He went to Egypt on 1 December that year and subsequently proceeded to France. By July 1916 he was serving as a Lieutenant in the Middlesex Regiment, attached to the 2nd Battalion, Royal Fusiliers. On 1 July 1916, the opening day of the Battle of the Somme, Paterson and the 2nd Royal Fusiliers took part in the attack towards Hawthorn Ridge and Beaumont-Hamel. At exactly 7:20 AM, a massive British mine hidden underneath the German fortification at Hawthorn Ridge was detonated, blowing a monumental crater into the earth. This signaled an immediate 10-minute British heavy artillery barrage before the infantry advanced. Because the infantry did not attack until 7:30 AM, the 10-minute gap gave surviving German machine gunners plenty of time to scramble out of their deep dugouts. They quickly set up defensive positions around the rim of the brand-new crater and along the undamaged parapets. When the whistle blew at 7:30 AM, Lieutenant Paterson and the men of the 2nd Royal Fusiliers climbed out of their trenches and advanced into No Man's Land toward Hawthorn Ridge. As soon as they stepped into the open, they were met by a devastating, cross-cutting wall of machine-gun and concentrated artillery fire. The battalion faced near-total annihilation trying to cross the open ground, and Lieutenant Paterson was among the wave of officers cut down in the first hours of the attack.

His body was never recovered or identified, and he was recorded as missing. Aged 23, he has no known grave and is commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial to the Missing of the Somme in France.

Paterson's military service followed that of his brother, Private James Cochrane Paterson, 2950, 'A' Company, 9th Battalion, Royal Sussex Regiment, who died on 21st October 1915, aged 25. He died of wounds while in German hands and is buried in grave XVII.A.11 in Cologne Southern Cemetery. Both brothers are recorded in the research as having died during the First World War.

Photos



Paterson Photo AI



Patterson Photo Original

Notes & Clippings

From CWGC memorial page: For Evermore: Stories of the Fallen – link above next to date of birth

“Alan was born in Hendon, Middlesex, on 22nd May 1893, the younger of two children, both sons of James (a clerk at the War Office) and Hannah Paterson of 26 Glenhouse Road, Eltham, London. [Note this year of birth doesn’t fit with his age as 35 when he died.]

He was employed as a bank clerk. He received a commission in the 14th Battalion, Middlesex Regiment, on 26th February 1915, went to Egypt on 1st December and afterwards proceeded to France.

Lieutenant Alan Paterson, Middlesex Regiment, attached to 2nd Battalion, Royal Fusiliers died on 1st July 1916, aged 23, during an attack towards Hawthorn Ridge.

Alan’s parents lost both their children in the war as his brother, Private James Cochrane Paterson, 2950, ‘A’ Company, 9th Battalion, Royal Sussex Regiment, died on 21st October 1915, aged 25. He died of wounds while in German hands and is buried in grave XVII.A.11 in Cologne Southern Cemetery.”

There is no indication of who submitted this information and there is no proof given for any of the facts.

Searching FreeBMD:

There is a marriage between James Paterson and Hannah Coker in the first quarter of 1889 (or possible Dec 1888) in Camberwell registration district

There is a birth of a James Cochrane Paterson between Jul-Sep 1890 registered in Hamstead registration district.

I couldn’t find Alan’s birth registered in England & Wales, however I found a baptism of an Allan Forster Paterson at Trinity Presbyterian Church in Camden (right parents). His first and middle names spelt incorrectly. The entry (original & saved from Ancestry) does provide date of birth 22/5/1893 as recorded in the CWGC memorial page. Baptism date 7/10/1893.

He is also registered as Allan Forster Paterson by the General Register Office (their index saved) that indicates his birth was registered in the Hendon registration district in the Jun quarter 1893.

Censuses:

In the 1911 Census (original saved from Ancestry) he is living with his brother and parents at 36 College Road, Harrow. Both he and his brothers are bank clerks. His father is a 1st Class Assistant Accountant in the War Office. The family are also employing a general servant. His father was born in Scotland and his mother born in Camberwell. His father would have filled out the census form and has spelt Alan's name as Alan Foster Paterson so I think we should take that as correct. Alan's place of birth is given as Child's Hill, Hendon, Middx.

In the 1901 Census the family were living on Headstone Road, Harrow

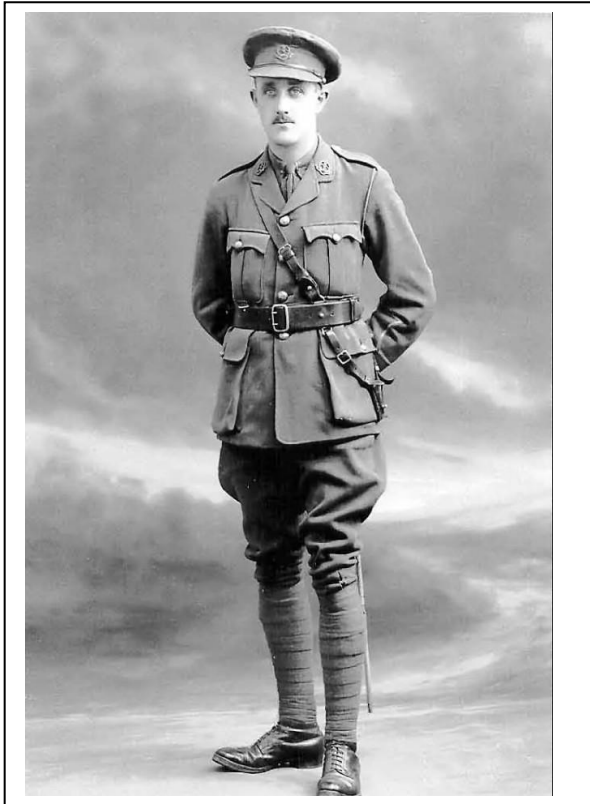


Image is from the CWGC memorial site. Copyright unknown.